

Topic D Why do we have phobias?

1. Explaining the question: Why do we have phobias?

Students will be assessed on their understanding of:

- a causes of phobias including:
 - i the evolutionary explanation of preparedness
 - ii Social Learning Theory (modelling and vicarious reinforcement)
 - iii classical/Pavlovian conditioning (association and generalisation)
- b the nature-nurture debate in relation to understanding phobias.

In the examination, students could be asked to demonstrate their understanding of stimulus material drawing on key terms and explanations.

2. Investigating the question: questionnaires

Students will be assessed on their understanding of:

- a the following terms and their use when referring to methodology:
 - i questionnaire
 - ii open-ended and closed questions
 - iii rank scales (eg Likert style questions)
 - iv standardised instructions
 - v response bias
 - vi social desirability.

In the examination, students could be asked to design a questionnaire from stimulus material, drawing on the terms above.

- b questionnaires as a research method including evaluation
- c ethical issues of laboratory experiments using animals including social isolation, number and choice of species
- d practical issues of laboratory experiments using animals including three practical issues
- e the aims, procedures and findings (results and/or conclusions) and evaluation of
 - i Cover-Jones (1924) *The case of Little Peter*
 - ii Bennett-Levy and Marteau (1984) *Fear of animals. What is prepared?*

3.**Why psychology matters**

Students will be assessed on their understanding of:

- a flooding and systematic desensitisation as therapies used to treat phobias
- b the ethics of flooding and systematic desensitisation as therapies used to treat phobias, including the guidelines of distress and right to withdraw
- c the role of a clinical psychologist including:
 - i who they might work for
 - ii what they do
 - iii skills required
 - iv qualifications required
 - v chartered status
 - vi what they might do to help a person with phobias.

4.**Exploring the question further**

Students will be assessed on their understanding of:

- a cultural issues in the development of phobias using Heinrichs et al, (2005) *Cultural differences in perceived social norms and social anxiety*.